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Kupina Hala

*A Traveler's Reference Grammar
for AR-29G's Lingua Franca*

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Archived at Orbital Archive Station L-9,
New New Earth (AB-16A),
Anserium Standard Date 02/01/7101

Contents

1	Introduction	2
2	Phonology	3
3	Pronouns	3
3.1	Personal Pronouns	3

1 Introduction

Kupina Hala (*Kupina Hala*, Kupina Hala: [ku'pina 'hala]) is the principal lingua franca of AR-29G and serves as the dominant medium of interregional communication throughout the planet.

The language was created one century after arrival to AR-29G, around 3105 SSD, by *Aranocles of Gasareia* as a liturgical and philosophical medium for the propagation of his Hiwariist doctrine. Contemporary documentary evidence indicates that the earliest form of Kupina Hala was an artificially constructed language employed by Aranocles and his immediate followers. Although initially regarded by local authorities as a marginal religious curiosity, the language spread rapidly alongside Hiwariist communities, transforming Kupina Hala from a sectarian liturgical code into the de facto common language of AR-29G.

Effective acquisition of Kupina Hala requires familiarity with several fundamental concepts of Hiwariist thought, as these are deeply embedded in the language's grammatical organization. Most notably, nouns and pronouns are classified according to the distinction between *yu* ('depters') and *yâpe* ('depteers'). This distinction derives from the Hiwariist doctrine of the *hîwarî*, an inner balance believed to be possessed by all entities.

Within Hiwariist cosmology, every entity possesses a *hîwarî*, conceived as a scale balancing two opposing tendencies: *yu*, associated with taking, possessing, and receiving, and *yâpe*, associated with giving, lacking, and relinquishing. Entities whose nature is perceived as primarily acquisitive—for example humans, who take sustenance and resources from their environment—are generally classified as *yu*. Conversely, entities understood as fundamentally generous or sustaining, such as the ocean or certain ecological systems, are typically classified as *yâpe*. Hiwariist doctrine further maintains that each *hîwarî* strives to restore balance when excessively displaced toward either state.

Although the theological foundations of these categories need not be adopted by off-world personnel, accurate use of Kupina Hala requires an operational understanding of them. Misclassification of individuals or entities may be interpreted as evidence of ignorance, social hostility, or theological dissent. Personnel assigned to long-term field operations are therefore strongly advised to familiarize themselves with local Hiwariist classifications and practices prior to deployment.

The present document provides a comprehensive descriptive account of Standard Kupina Hala, including its phonological system, morphological structures, and syntactic organization, in accordance with the archival and validation standards of the Senate's Interstellar Language Bureau.

2 Phonology

Because of Kupina Hala’s role as a lingua franca in AR-29G, considerable dialectal variation exists. While many phonemes admit multiple realizations across these dialects, following the pronunciations shown in the following chart will make you understood by everyone without raising too many eyebrows.

	Labial	Alveolar	Palatal	Glottal
Plosive	p	t		k
Nasal	m	n		
Fricative		s	ç	h
Sonorant	w	l r	j	

Table 1: Consonant Inventory

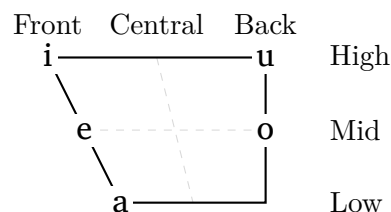


Table 2: Vowel Chart

All sounds are transcribed with their corresponding IPA symbols, except for **<x>** /**ç**/ and **<y>** /**j**/. Vowels can appear accompanied by a circumflex mark **<â ê î ô û>**, which marks stress rather than a change in vowel quality; without it, stress falls in the penultimate syllable.

Syllables in Kupina Hala follow a simple (C)V(N) structure, where they have a mandatory vowel nucleus, can optionally start with any consonant and can optionally end with **<n>**.

3 Pronouns

3.1 Personal Pronouns

Personal pronouns distinguish three persons (first, second, and third), two numbers (singular and plural), four cases—Nominative (NOM), Accusative (ACC), Dative (DAT), and Genitive (GEN)—and a distinction between *yu* (depters) and *yâpe* (depteers). This distinction relates to the planet’s main faith and is explained in more detail in the section about nouns.

Person	NOM	ACC	DAT	GEN
1st	<i>ya / yo</i>	<i>isa / iso</i>	<i>ika / iko</i>	<i>ipa / ipo</i>
2nd	<i>sa / so</i>	<i>osa / oso</i>	<i>oka / oko</i>	<i>opa / opo</i>
3rd	<i>la / e</i>	<i>ase / se</i>	<i>aka / eko</i>	<i>apa / epo</i>

Table 3: Personal pronouns. The plural is regularly marked with the **<-n>** suffix. In each pair, the first form refers to *yu* entities and the second to *yâpe* entities.

In the first and second persons, the distinction between *yu* and *yâpe* is expressed through vowel alternation. Forms containing *a* refer to *yu* entities, whereas forms containing *o* refer to *yâpe* entities.

Because Hiwariist doctrine maintains that the average human's *hîwarî* cannot naturally be inclined towards the *yâpe*, the use of *yâpe* forms of the first-person pronouns is generally regarded as pretentious and is reserved for individuals of exceptional generosity or religious significance.

Similarly, the use of the *yâpe* forms of the second-person pronouns constitutes a formal and honorific mode of address, indicating that the speaker considers the addressee to be exceptionally generous or virtuous.

Third-person pronouns employ distinct, suppletive forms for the two categories. These forms must be used in accordance with the conventional classification of nouns into *depters* and *depteers*. Failure to employ the appropriate form is generally interpreted as evidence of ignorance on the part of the speaker regarding the proper functioning of the world.